Electronic mail

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Overview

- Email is a method of exchanging digital messages from an author to one or more recipients.
- Email is like sending a letter, only you send the message over the internet and it gets to the other person's email account within seconds.
- If you have an email address, you can email anyone else who has an email address.
- Once you've got an email account, you can store your emails on the internet, or store them on a computer, laptop or another internet-connected device.

Key benefits and features of using email

- It's quick – your recipient receives your email as soon as they go online and collect their mail.
- It's secure.
- It’s of low cost.
- Photos, documents and other files can be attached to an email, so that more information can be shared.
- One email can be sent to more than one recipient at a time.

Additional information

- If your email is stored on the web, it's called 'webmail'.
- To access a webmail account, you get onto the internet, go to the website where your webmail is hosted and 'log in' or 'sign in' with your username and password.

Email addresses

- Email addresses use a standard formula.
- They are always separated into two parts by the @ symbol.

- The first part of the email address identifies the user.
- You can use real names for the first part of your email address, or you could use a nickname that your friends and family will recognize.
- The second part of an email address comes from your webmail provider or the internet service provider you use.
- This gives a standard formula for all email addresses which will look something like firstname.surname@somewhere.com.au or yournickname@somewhere.com.au

Using email

- All email accounts have the same basic features.
- They will have an **'inbox'** for the emails you've received.
- There will also be a **'sent'** items folder where the emails that you've sent to other people can be saved.
- And there will be an **'address book'** or contacts list where you can save other people's email addresses.

Sending emails

- You can create new emails to send to people.
- Creating a new email might be called 'compose', 'create', or 'new email'.
- To send an email, you type the email address or email addresses into the 'to' field.
- There is usually also a 'cc' field and a 'bcc' field showing that you can use to send copies of this email to other people.
- In the subject field, you usually tell the other person what the email is about and then write the email in the body field.
- You can also attach files to emails including photos and documents.

- When you click send, the email is sent to the other person's email account over the internet.
- They'll get your email the next time they log into their account.
- If the email didn't reach the other person, you'll usually get an automated email telling you that the email was undeliverable.
- This could be because
  - The email address was spelled incorrectly,
  - You accidently included spaces,
  - Or sometimes it's because the other person's inbox is full and can't receive any more emails until they delete some emails to make space for new ones.

Replying to emails

- If someone emails you, you can reply to them by selecting the **'reply'** button.
- You then write back to them and then select **'send'.**

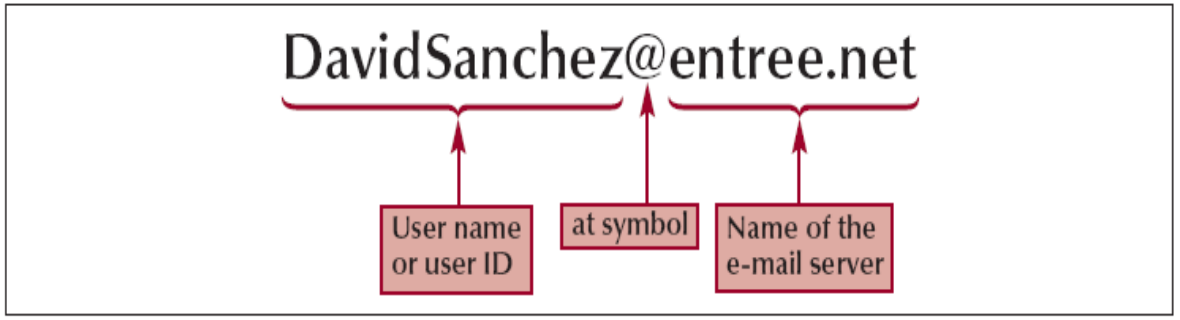
Forwarding emails

- And if you receive an email that you'd like to share with someone else, you can forward the email to other people by selecting the **'forward'** button, putting in the other people's email addresses, typing in a message and selecting **'send'.**

Getting Started with Windows Mail

- Just as you must address a piece of ordinary mail, you need to supply an address for an e-mail message.

Figure 4-17 Typical format of an e-mail address



Getting Started with Windows Mail

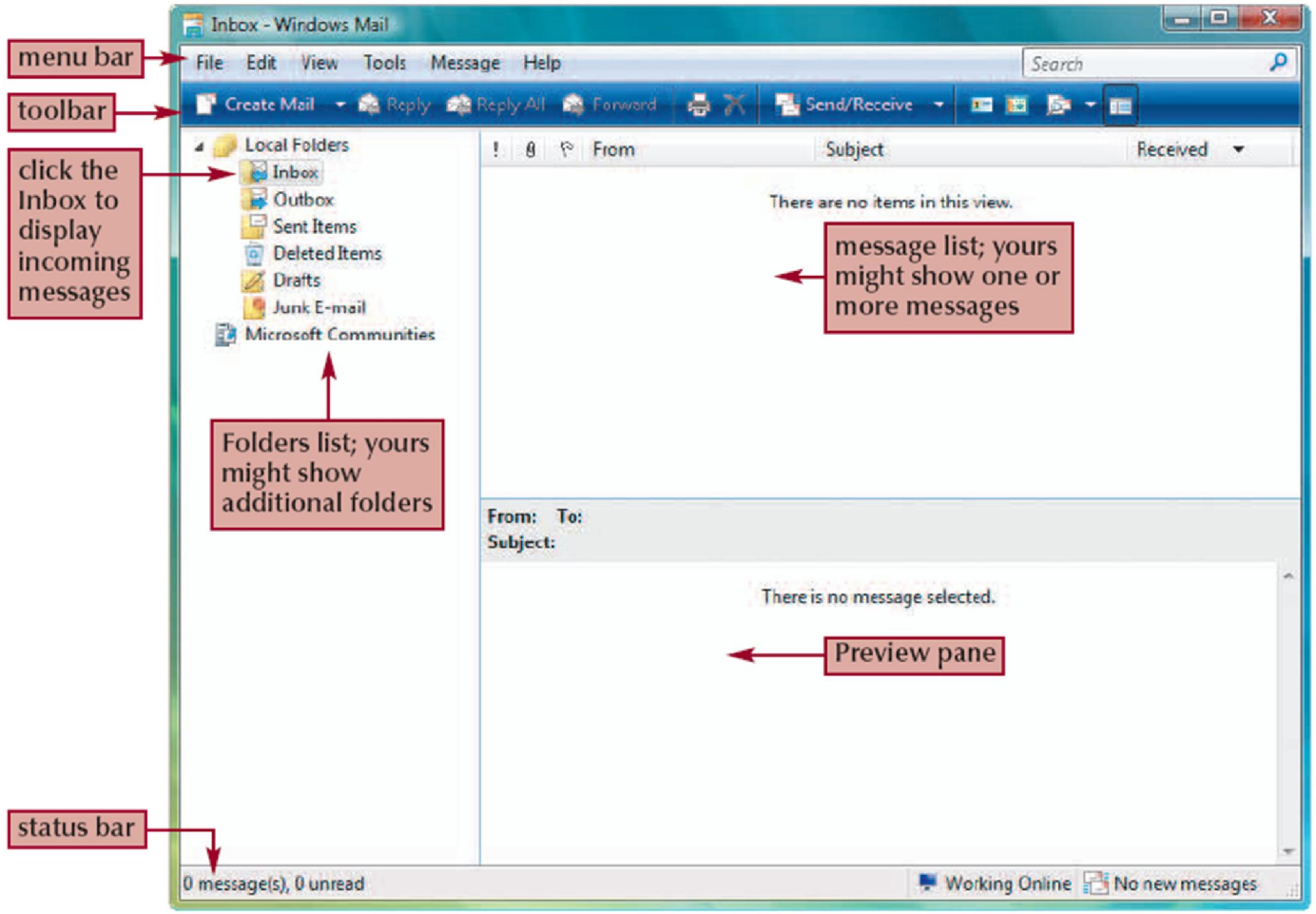
- Respond only as necessary
- State your subject clearly
- Don’t e-mail sensitive or confidential information
- Be concise and direct
- Avoid abbreviations
- Don’t use all capital letters
- Pause and reread before sending

Setting Up Windows Mail

- Windows Mail supports three types of e-mail accounts
  - **Post Office Protocol 3 (POP3)**
  - **Internet Message Access Protocol (IMAP)**
  - **Simple Mail Transfer Protocol (SMTP)**
- The first time you start Windows Mail, a series of dialog boxes guides you through the process of setting up an account

Sending and Receiving E-mail Using Windows Mail

Windows Mail window **Figure 4-18**

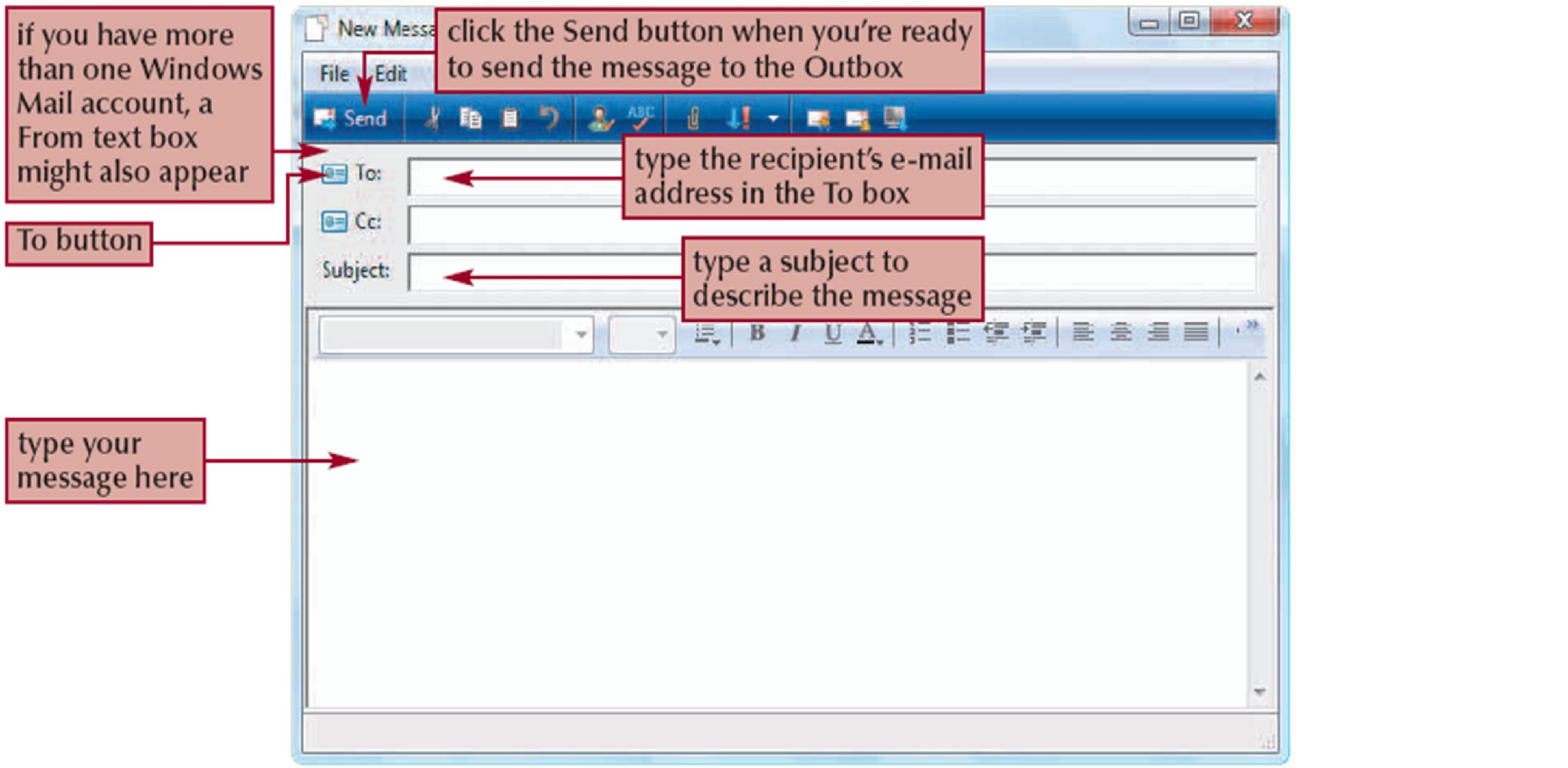


Creating and Sending an E-mail Message

- Click the Create Mail button on the toolbar
- Enter the e-mail address of the recipient in the To box
- Click the Subject box and then type the subject of the message
- Click the message area and then type the content of the message
- Click the Send button

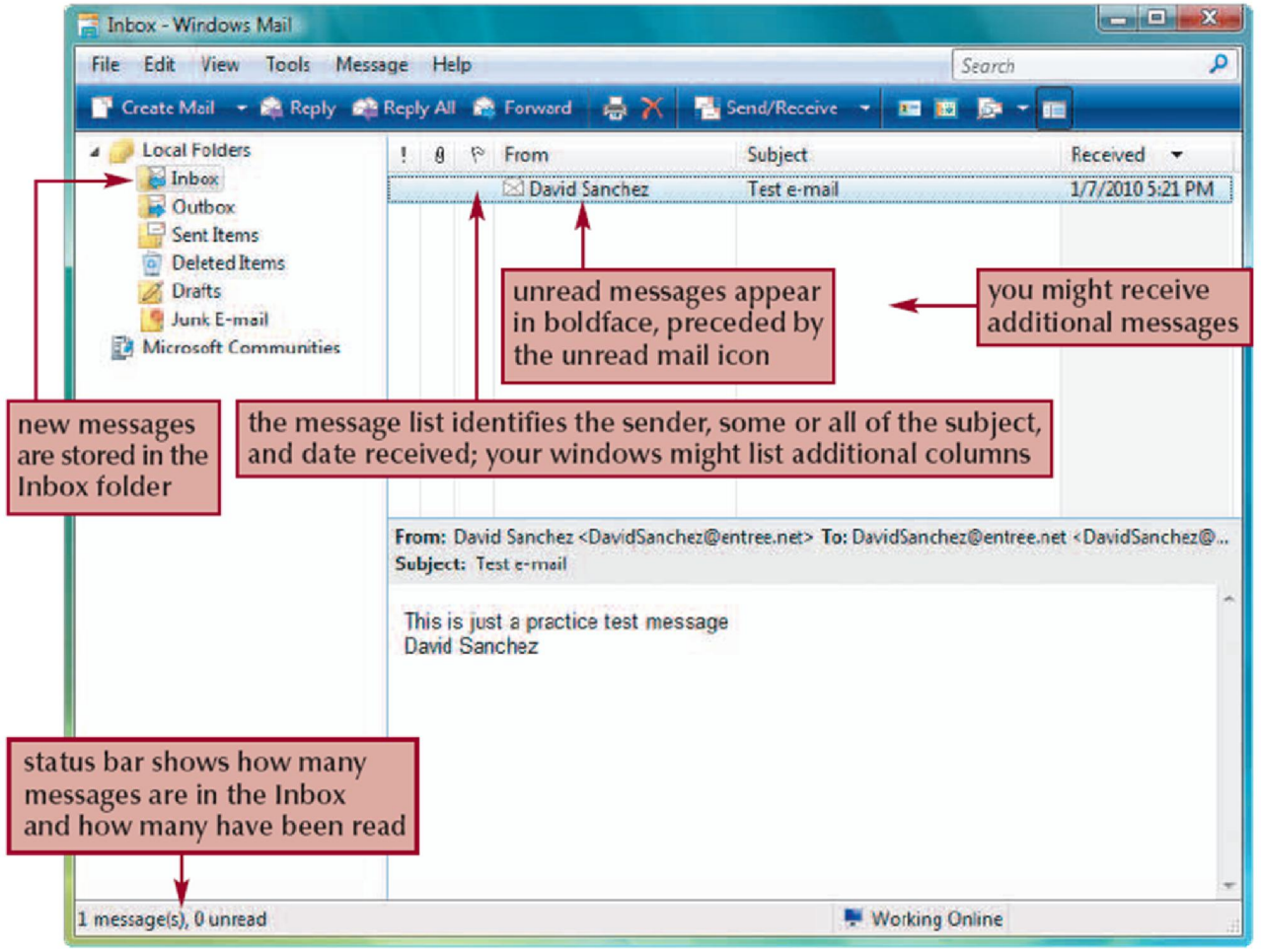
Creating and Sending an E-mail Message

New Message window **Figure 4-19**



Receiving an E-mail Message

Inbox folder **Figure 4-21**



Adding Information to Windows Contacts

- Click Tools on the menu bar, and then click Windows Contacts
- Click the New Contact button on the toolbar
- Enter new contact’s information in the Properties dialog box
- Click OK

or

- Click an e-mail message in the message list
- Click Tools on the menu bar, then click Add Sender to Contacts
- Enter new contact’s information in the Properties dialog box
- Click OK